TRAIL TOOL

Dollar Tracker: Where Does My Money Go?

Most people think they know where their money goes, until they actually look.

The Dollar Tracker is a reality check, not a budget. Write down where your money went, big and small, with no judging. Choose the option that fits your situation. Both give you the same thing: a clearer picture of your spending patterns. Rough estimates are fine.

Fill in Option A, Option B, or both. Rounded or practice numbers work just as well as exact ones.

Two ways to use this handout. It matches the Dollar Tracker in the Pathfinder Guidebook. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. You'll use it for Question 1 of Mile Marker #5. You never have to share your tracker. If you want to attach it, that's your choice.

NAME

WEEK OF

OPTION A

Look back at the past 7 days

Where did your money go? Rename any category so it fits your life.

Category	Amount
Food: groceries	$
Food: eating out or delivery	$
Transportation: gas or rideshare	$
School: books, fees, supplies	$
Subscriptions: streaming, apps, music	$
Personal: toiletries, clothing	$
Bills: phone, rent, utilities	$
Social: going out, gifts	$
Random or impulse buys	$
	$
	$
	$
Estimated total spent	**$**

OPTION B

Track every purchase for the next 7 days

Write down every purchase this week, big or small. No judging.

Day	What you bought	Category	Amount
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
			$
		Week total	**$**

LOOKING BACK

What did you notice?

What surprised you the most?

Which category took more than you expected?

Where did small purchases add up?

One thing you'd do differently next week, not because you have to, but because it would feel better